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Anqi Wang

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Areas of Specialization

Philosophy of science, Causation and causal explanation

Areas of Competence

Logic, Metaphysics, Philosophy of biology, Philosophy of AI

Education

University of Leeds
PhD, Philosophy — 2022-present

Nanjing University
M.A., Philosophy
First-Prize Scholarship — 2019-2022

North-East Normal University
B.S., Environmental Science — 2015-2019

Dissertation

Choosing variables for SEM-based causal explanations

- My dissertation investigates variable choice in SEM-based causal explanation and develops perspicuity as a new criterion for explanatory preferability, while reassessing modularity and proportionality within interventionist causation.

Supervisors: Juha Saatsi, Helen Beebee
External examiner: Lina Jansson (Nottingham University)

Presentations

A trilemma of the Woodwardian definition of proportionality — Jan 2026
APA Eastern Division, Baltimore

A trilemma of the Woodwardian definition of proportionality — Nov 2025
HPS Working-in-Progress Workshop, Leeds

Can structural equation models provide perspicuous explanations? Revisiting the Hodgkin-Huxley model — Nov 2025
PSA Around the World 2025, Online

Can structural equation models provide perspicuous explanations? Revisiting the Hodgkin-Huxley model
British Society for the Philosophy of Science (BSPS), Glasgow — July 2025

Can structural equation models provide perspicuous explanations? Revisiting the Hodgkin-Huxley model
Young Scholars Workshop on Philosophy of Science, Shanghai — June 2025

From statistical correlation to causal interpretation: The role of ideal intervention
MCMP Summer School, Munich — July 2024

Contrastive explanation
Philosophy PGR Seminar, Leeds — May 2023

Research in Progress

Perspicuity and parametric representation—a novel criterion for better explanation

Non-functional causal relationships as a challenge for proportionality

Insensitivity makes modularity possible

The limitation of single-equation-based explanations

How to choose the cause from contrastive explanations? — a challenge from trade-off cases

Teaching

Tutorial

Introduction to the history of Western philosophy
Level 1 module — 2023-2024 / 2024-2025 Fall

- The module covers philosophers from ancient Greece through to the eighteenth century, as well as their major ideas and contributions. Topics include Plato's World of Forms, Confucius's concept of li (ritual), Descartes' dualism, and modern and contemporary women philosophers and feminist philosophy, etc.

How science works
Level 1 module — 2023-2024 / 2024-2025 Spring

- The module covers theory-laden observation, scientific realism, the problem of induction, the value-free ideal of science, Kuhn and the

scientific revolutions, etc.

Philosophy of biology
Level 2 & 3 module

- The module covers the metaphysics of pregnancy, scientific models, the evolution of morality, natural selection and the traits of organisms, the ontology of disease, biological natural kind, etc. — 2024-2025 Spring

Module Design
Evolution of morality

- This module examines how evolutionary processes may explain the origins of morality and what such explanations imply for moral knowledge and justification. It covers kin selection, reciprocal altruism, game theory, and evolutionary debunking arguments. — 2025 Spring
- Independently designed the module and the syllabus, learning objectives, and teaching materials; Designed and produced lecture slides; Delivered lectures; Planned and led the corresponding seminar.

Services

Conference assistant, BSPS 2026

- Coordinated the scheduling and grouping of all contributed talks and symposia;
- Managed email correspondence with conference participants; — July 2026
- Produced and edited the conference booklet;
- Provided on-site support throughout the conference.